Theodora Otelea

BRAND MARKETING & CREATIVE STRATEGIST

Luxury Hospitality · Lifestyle · Experiences

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PRE-SETTLED STATUS — ELIGIBLE TO WORK IN THE UK

PORTFOLIO — THEODORA794.GITHUB.IO/THEODORA-PORTFOLIO

PROFILE

I develop ideas and campaigns for hospitality and lifestyle businesses: positioning, storytelling, and the film, photography, social and live experiences that carry them. My current work is with InterContinental Athénée Palace and its restaurants and bars. Before marketing, I worked in product and sales across European travel markets, which is where my commercial grounding comes from.

SELECTED IMPACT

2M+	Organic reach on Meta from campaign work at InterContinental Athénée Palace
No. 1	On LinkedIn in the hotel's competitor set — held since summer 2024
27→68%	Group booking conversion at HotelPlanner, within my first months
150	Hotels added to the HotelPlanner portfolio in South-Eastern Europe
3rd	Place, Marketeer of the Year — IHG Hotels & Resorts, Malta 2025

EXPERIENCE

Digital Marketing Coordinator

2023 — PRESENT

INTERCONTINENTAL ATHÉNÉE PALACE BUCHAREST

Marketing, creative direction and PR for a 110-year-old hotel and its restaurants and bars, while InterContinental repositioned the property.

- **Café Athénée — rebrand & reopening.** Played a pivotal role in the rebrand. The café was still being renovated, so the renovation became the idea: I wrote the story and the social voice, directed the photography, and ran the PR and influencer work up to the *A Classy Breakfast Affair* reopening.
- **The English Bar, est. 1914.** Co-created *The Secrets of the English Bar* , a four-episode campaign that opens in 1914 in black and white and finishes in colour once the room reopened. Planned the campaign, wrote the copy, supervised the video and visual identity, and directed on set.
- **JORJ — *Fire & Ice* opening.** Co-created the concept and led the storytelling: a fire side and an ice side joined by a lit bridge, with a *Chic Contrast* dress code. Guerlain, Ruinart, Moët and Teilor were built into the experience rather than added as sponsors.
- **Consumer campaigns.** *110 Years of Athénée Palace*, *Why We Love Bucharest*, *Summer Events Guide* and the festive programmes: the work behind the 2M+ organic reach on Meta.
- **Employer brand on LinkedIn.** Wrote and directed two original series, *Why We Love Bucharest* (61,904 impressions) and *Driven by Passion, Defined by Hospitality* , which took the hotel to first place in its competitor set.
- **Production & PR.** Wrote the briefs and directed on set for 10+ films and photo shoots with outside production companies, including the festive, Valentine's and Women's Day films. Press releases, PR and influencer partnerships, and bringing the hotel's heritage spaces (Le Diplomate, Les Colonnades, the dining rooms) into campaign and press stories. Interviewed by *Biz Magazine* on five-star experiences, 2024.

EXPERIENCE CONTINUED

Brand & Content Strategist *(Freelance)*
2025 — 2026

AVENCYX — CYBERSECURITY STARTUP, BUCHAREST

— Built the identity and tone of voice from scratch and set up four content pillars, putting technical cybersecurity subjects into language a general audience can follow.

— Produced a 10-film series on data privacy, with templates for founder posts, industry trends and case studies, plus campaign assets for the pre-listing phase.

Product Manager, South-Eastern Europe
2021 — 2023

HOTELPLANNER — TRAVEL TECHNOLOGY, WEST PALM BEACH (REMOTE)

— Group booking conversion rose **from 27% to 68%** in my first months in the role.

— Managed and grew the South-Eastern European portfolio, **adding 150 hotels** , with partnerships across hotel groups, OTAs and affiliates in a marketplace serving Expedia, Hotels.com, Priceline and Agoda.

— Led sales strategy for leisure, MICE and corporate groups, ran monthly partner webinars, adapted the platform for European markets and represented the company at tourism trade shows.

EMEA International Sales Specialist
2019 — 2021

HOTELPLANNER — LONDON

— Handled 40+ client accounts a day at a 5% conversion rate, putting together booking solutions and itineraries, and bringing on new partners.

Contracting Agent *(Internship)*
2019

HOTELPLANNER — LONDON

— Found and onboarded new hotel partners, helped negotiate contracts and keep supplier relationships running, and worked on marketing that promoted key platform features.

PPC Specialist *(Internship)*
2023

CANOPY — BUCHAREST

— Built and ran paid search and social campaigns on Google Ads and Meta: campaign setup, ad copy testing and performance reporting.

EARLY CAREER

Front Desk Receptionist · Hotel Caro, Bucharest · 2018 — guest arrivals and payments.

Volunteer Coordinator · O Masă Caldă (NGO), Bucharest · 2017 — 2020 — meal services and volunteers.

EDUCATION

BA (Hons) Business with Marketing, 2:1 · University of Greenwich, London · 2021

Key Essentials: The Wealth Economy, Sustainable Development and the Law · University of Cambridge, Lucy Cavendish College · 2025 — completed with scholarship.

RECOGNITION

3rd Place, Marketeer of the Year · IHG Hotels & Resorts Annual Commercial Conference Gala, Malta · 2025

Commitment to Excellence Award · HotelPlanner, four years of service · 2022

Supervisory Skills Development, IHG University · Google Ads & PPC certifications, 2023

CAPABILITIES

Brand Strategy · Brand Positioning · Creative Strategy & Concept Development · Integrated Campaigns · Experiential & Event Concepts · Storytelling & Content · Pre-Opening & Launch · PR & Influencer Marketing · Creative Direction · Partnership Development · Paid Media · Commercial & Sales Strategy · Project & Stakeholder Management

LANGUAGES

Romanian — native · English — bilingual · French — limited working proficiency